

Zhenghao Zeng

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Research Interests	Causal inference, nonparametric statistics, high-dimensional statistics	
Academic Position	Stanford University	Stanford, CA
	Postdoc Scholar at Graduate School of Business	09/2025 – present
	Mentors: Prof. Stefan Wager, Ramesh Johari and Guido Imbens	
Education	Carnegie Mellon University	Pittsburgh, PA
	Ph.D. in Statistics	08/2020 – 08/2025
	Advisor: Prof. Edward H. Kennedy	
	Carnegie Mellon University	Pittsburgh, PA
	M.S. in Statistics	08/2020 – 05/2021
	University of Science and Technology of China	Hefei, Anhui
	B.S. in Statistics	08/2016 – 06/2020
Honors and Awards	Umesh K. Gavaskar Memorial Thesis Award, Department of Statistics and Data Science, Carnegie Mellon University	
	2026	
	Student Paper Award, Statistical Learning and Data Science Section, ASA	
	2024	
	ENAR Distinguished Student Paper Award, International Biometric Society	
	2023	
	Guo Moruo Scholarship, USTC's highest undergraduate honor	
	2019	
	National Scholarship of China, USTC	
	2018	
Publications	Zeng, Z. , Arbour, D., Feller, A., Dasgupta, I., Sinha, A., and Kennedy, E. H. Handling Missing Responses under Cluster Dependence with Applications to Language Model Evaluation. <i>Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems</i> , 2025.	
	Levis, A. W., Bonvini, M., Zeng, Z. , Keele, L., and Kennedy, E. H. (2023). Covariate-assisted bounds on causal effects with instrumental variables. <i>Journal of the Royal Statistical Society Series B: Statistical Methodology</i> , qkaf028.	
	Du, J. H., Zeng, Z. , Kennedy, E. H., Wasserman, L., and Roeder, K. (2025). Causal inference for genomic data with multiple heterogeneous outcomes. <i>Journal of the American Statistical Association</i> , (just-accepted), 1-24.	
	Zeng, Z. , Kennedy, E. H., Bodnar, L. M., and Naimi, A. I. (2023). Efficient generalization and transportation. arXiv preprint arXiv:2302.00092. Accepted by <i>Statistical Science</i> .	

Zeng, Z., Arbour, D., Feller, A., Addanki, R., Rossi, R., Sinha, R., and Kennedy, E.H. (2024). Continuous Treatment Effects with Surrogate Outcomes. *International Conference on Machine Learning*, 2024.

Zeng, Z., Gu, Y., and Xu, G. (2023). A Tensor-EM Method for Large-Scale Latent Class Analysis with Binary Responses. *Psychometrika*, 88(2), 580-612.

He, Y., Meng, B., **Zeng, Z.**, and Xu, G. (2021). On the phase transition of Wilks' phenomenon. *Biometrika*, 108(3), 741-748.

Preprints

Zeng, Z., Adjaho, C., Bucarey, A., Qin, C., Zhang, R., Hoban, P., Johari, R. and Wager, S. (2026). Sequentially Rerandomized Switchback Experiments. arXiv preprint arXiv:2604.02489.

Zeng, Z., Levis, A.W., Lee, J.H., Kennedy, E.H., and Keele, L. (2025). Nonparametric Estimation of Local Treatment Effects with Continuous Instruments. arXiv preprint arXiv:2504.03063.

Zeng, Z., Balakrishnan, S., Han, Y., and Kennedy, E. H. (2024). Causal Inference with High-dimensional Discrete Covariates. arXiv preprint arXiv:2405.00118.

Bonvini, M., **Zeng, Z.**, Yu, M., Kennedy, E. H., and Keele, L. (2023). Flexibly Estimating and Interpreting Heterogeneous Treatment Effects of Laparoscopic Surgery for Cholecystitis Patients. arXiv preprint arXiv:2311.04359.

Experience

Adobe Research San Jose, CA
Research Intern 05/2024 – 08/2024
Mentors: David Arbour, Ishita Dasgupta, Atanu Sinha and Avi Feller (Berkeley)
Handling missing responses under cluster dependence with applications to language model evaluation.

Adobe Research San Jose, CA
Research Intern 05/2023 – 08/2023
Mentors: David Arbour and Avi Feller (Berkeley)
Continuous treatment effects with surrogate outcomes.

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor Ann Arbor, MI
Research Assistant 06/2019 – 09/2019
Mentor: Prof. Gongjun Xu
Large-scale latent class analysis and high-dimensional testing.

Teaching

Teaching assistant, Carnegie Mellon University 08/2020–05/2022

36-225 Introduction to Probability
 36-401 Modern Regression
 36-402 Advanced Methods for Data Analysis (×2)

Teaching assistant, USTC

09/2019 – 05/2020

Single-variable Calculus

Regression Analysis

Talks

Econometrics Lunch

Stanford, CA

Causal inference with high-dimensional discrete covariates

01/2025

International Conference on Computational & Methodological Statistics (CMStatistics)

Virtual

Continuous treatment effects with surrogate outcomes

12/2024

Joint Statistical Meetings (JSM)

Portland, OR

Causal inference with high-dimensional discrete covariates

08/2024

American Causal Inference Conference (ACIC)

Seattle, WA

Causal inference with high-dimensional discrete covariates

05/2024

Causal Inference and Missing Data Group at Inria

Virtual

Efficient generalization and transportation

02/2024

American Causal Inference Conference (ACIC)

Austin, TX

Causal inference with high-dimensional discrete covariates

05/2023

International Biometric Society ENAR Spring Meeting

Nashville, TN

Efficient generalization and transportation

03/2023

Academic Service

Reviewer

Annals of Statistics (1)

American Journal of Epidemiology (1)

Biometrika (5)

Biostatistics (2)

Computational Statistics (1)

Electronic Journal of Statistics (5)

Journal of American Statistical Association (10)

Journal of Causal Inference (5)

Journal of Machine Learning Research (1)

Journal of the Royal Statistical Society: Series B (2)

NeurIPS (5)

Stat (1)

Statistics in Medicine (1)

Statistica Sinica (1)

The American Statistician (1)

Organizer

CMU Causal Inference Reading Group (2024-2025)